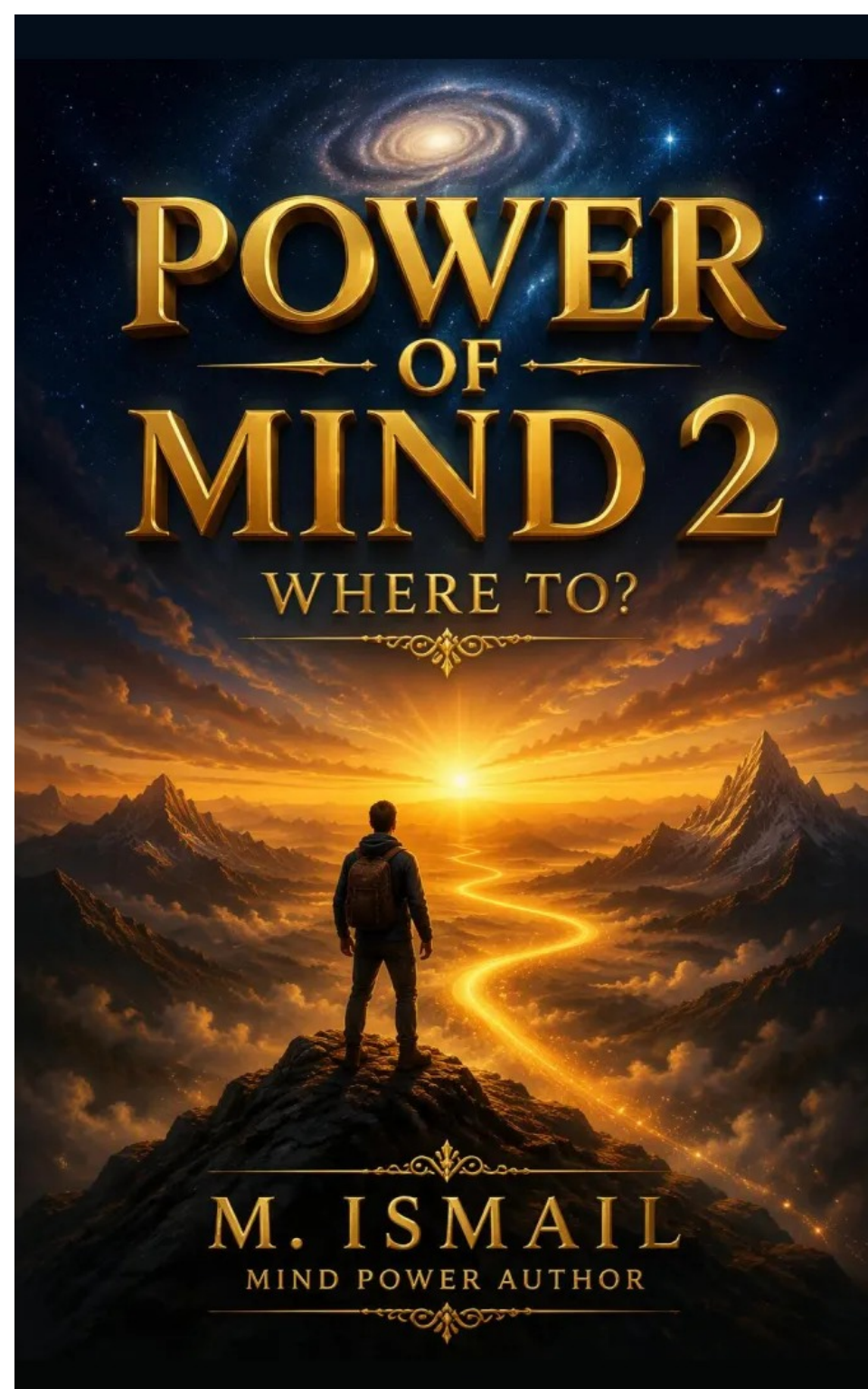


The background of the entire image is a composite of two scenes. The top half shows a dark blue night sky filled with stars and a large, bright spiral galaxy. The bottom half shows a person from behind, standing on a rocky mountain peak. They are looking out over a vast landscape of jagged, snow-capped mountains under a dramatic sunset or sunrise. A bright, glowing, wavy path of light leads from the person's feet towards the horizon where the sun is setting. The overall color palette is dominated by deep blues, oranges, and yellows.

POWER OF MIND 2

WHERE TO?

M. ISMAIL

MIND POWER AUTHOR

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WHERE TO?

Turning the power of your mind into a direction

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POWER OF MIND 2 — Where To? — Turning the power of your
mind into a direction

First Edition — 2026

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Introduction

After Part One came out, a message arrived from a reader — the kind that makes any author's day. He wrote: "I did the 21-day plan for real. I sleep better, the voice in my head is calmer, and I can finally start things I'd been running from for years. One thing keeps throwing me, though: my life is still standing in the same place. I took hold of my mind... so where am I going?"

I read that message more than once. Because the person who sent it had reached something few people reach: he no longer just wants control... he wants arrival.

And this book was written to answer him.

Part One of **Power of Mind** was about the most important battle of your life: taking back your mind. A clean, internal battle — you against the machine in your head. And if you carried out its plan — even with difficulty — you won something that can't be bought: you became the one operating your mind, not the one it operates.

But right here there's a trap.

If you stop there, you'll find yourself a full year later with: an organized mind, quiet thoughts, a good feeling of control... and a life exactly as it was. Like a man who bought a car in perfect condition, sat inside it, and started the engine... and went nowhere. An engine running in neutral: energy, sound, a feeling of life — and not a single centimetre moved.

Control is not arrival.

That sentence is the key to this entire book. Mastering your mind is the beginning of the journey... not its end. Because the mind — as we saw in Part One — is a tool. And a tool's permanent question is: what are you building?

This book is about turning the power you took back into a direction. It carries the same promise Part One was built on, in a deliberate sequence:

First, you will know where you're going — because the first difference between someone who's moving and someone who's just spinning isn't speed... it's destination.

Then you'll make a decision — a decision taken in a certain frame that's different from a wish, and we'll clear from its path most of the arguments that waste your years.

Then you'll hold — because any real road has a gap between the day you plant and the day you harvest, and that's exactly where people break.

After that you'll look at who's around you — Part One taught you who charges you... this part will show you what people quietly slip into you without you noticing.

And finally — most importantly — you'll ask: my power, in service of whom? Because power that serves no one... turns on its owner.

The same shape you've grown used to: a short true-life story you'll live with me, then the idea in simple points, then one exercise you finish in minutes, and at the end of each chapter a sentence of the week — one you memorize and live with for seven days — and a small surprise that hands you off to the next chapter. And at the end, a full plan — 90 days — a natural continuation of the 21-day plan that closed Part One: from consolidation... to launch.

One important note before we move: this book is a ladder... not a sequel. The tools of Part One — the observer, the one minute, the intentional repetition — are the foundation every chapter here is built on. If your tools have gone cold and slipped back, return to Part One first. It's not a flaw... it's exactly what the first book called: returning is half the knowledge.

One last thing before we begin. Part One stood, from the first page, on a single sentence:

Your mind is not you.

And this part stands on a second sentence — if you truly understand it, you'll see your life from a new angle:

Power without a direction... wastes its owner.

From the next page, we continue the journey.

Chapter One: Where To?

There's a question no one asks themselves except in counted moments: the last night of the year, the night of losing someone dear, or a coincidence years in the making. A question of only two words, and if you learn to answer it honestly, you'll save yourself years of running in circles:

"Where to?"

Don't be fooled by how simple it looks. Most people, if asked right now, could tell you everything about their day: the work, the obligations, the problems, the week's plan. But the question isn't "what are you doing?" ... it's "where are you going?" — and that's a question about direction, not motion. And the difference between the two is what this whole chapter is about. Get it right, and the next six chapters open up for you without effort... just as the first chapter of Part One opened the rest for you.

And we'll begin the way we always begin... with a story.

Karim's Story, and the Question at the Station

Karim is thirty-four. An accountant at a firm in downtown. His day is locked by anyone's standards: a

seven o'clock wake-up by force, two hours of transport, eight hours at a desk, a one-hour lunch where the same talk repeats at the same table, and at night a phone that takes half his free time. A busy man. And if you asked him "what are you doing with your life?" he'd answer word for word: "I don't have time to breathe."

The story happened on a Thursday night, at a petrol station on the Corniche.

Karim was standing to fill the car, the queue was long, and a guy looked over from the next pump and laughed: "Karim?!"

Khaled. University friend. He hadn't seen him in six years — since graduation day when the class scattered. They hugged in the middle of the station and the small gathering sat on the pavement: "How are you? Where've you been all this time?"

Karim gave the official answer — the one we all give: "Praise be to God. Working. Life goes on. Busy, you know."

Khaled laughed and said it lightly, a joke in a coffee-ground gathering on the ground:

"Busy... going where?"

The question came out without anyone putting weight on it. But what happened after that sentence was strange: Karim opened his mouth to answer... and stopped.

Not because the question was hard. Because the answer wasn't there to begin with. He tried "at my work" — but six years in the same company, same office, same chair. He tried "at my home" — but the home is fixed as it's been since the apartment contract was signed... no, let's say: the home is standing as it is. He tried "at myself" — and laughed at himself from inside, because what he had on that front was exactly what he had on graduation day: the same dreams... postponed the same way.

Khaled didn't feel the pause. He carried on with his stories, left him his number, and they parted on good terms. But Karim caught it that night while washing his face in front of the mirror. He stopped and asked himself the question himself:

"Where am I going?"

And there was no answer.

Let's do Karim's math in numbers — because numbers don't lie:

- Two hours of transport a day, in 250 working days a year = **500 hours** on the road.
- Eight hours at a desk $\times 5$ days $\times 48$ weeks = more than **1,900 hours** at the office.
- Three hours on the phone a day $\times 365$ days = more than **1,000 hours** on the screen.

The total: about **3,400 hours a year**. A full year of a man's life moving in, round the clock, on the hour. The yield of those years in one direction he chose himself, with full clarity: **zero**.

Not because Karim is lazy. Karim is a genuinely tired man — and that's what makes the story hurt. Because he never defined a destination... for a reason that's not written in his ledger.

The Taxi Meter

There's a scene that's stayed in my head for years: the taxi meter.

The taxi moves more than any car on the street. It circles the whole city every day: east and west, north and south, airport and squares. And the meter beside it keeps counting: five, twenty, a hundred... and by night it's up. The number says "motion." But the number

doesn't ask the important question: "going where?" — the meter asks "how much?" and nothing more.

And at the end of the night, the taxi has circled every corner of the city... and not one of them was "its destination." It follows other people's destinations: a passenger wants the courthouse, a passenger wants the school, a passenger wants home. The cars move... and the destination is always someone else's.

And your mind works on exactly that system when you have no destination: it records "how much" — an email answered, a call made, an errand run, an appointment kept — and by the end of the day your feeling is "a full day." But by the end of the year: the same office, the same home, the same postponed dreams. The meter's up... and the place is fixed.

And more dangerous than that: the meter gives a false feeling of progress. "I'm tired" is sometimes read as "I'm moving" — and the two are not the same. The tiredness of motion is real and respectable... but it's not proof of arrival. And that explains something that baffles many people: a man working hard and persistently for years, watching a colleague whose "work is lighter" get promoted and move forward every year. The difference isn't in the motion... it's in the question the meter can't ask.

The Idea in Points

First: The mind is a navigation system... and it needs a destination to start

Open Google Maps on your phone. The screen loads fast, the map appears, your location shows in blue, everything's ready. But until you type where you're going... no route will be drawn. The system isn't broken — there's nothing for it to calculate.

And your mind is the greatest navigation system ever born. It calculates routes, compares alternatives, learns from mistakes, and stores every trip you've taken. A magnificent system. But it has one clear condition since it was made: **it needs a destination**. The moment you set one, it works with you at once: it opens a road, draws your attention to something that serves the direction, leaves you a signal on an opportunity along the way.

And if there's no destination? The system doesn't shut down... it switches. It runs "fire-fighting mode": a call — answer. A notification — look. A problem — put it out. A task demanded — done. The system is genuinely running... but you're not the one deciding where the fire is.

Part One taught: "Who doesn't see doesn't choose."
That was the first door. And this is the second door,
and deeper: **"Who defines no destination... tires out
without arriving."** And the big trick is that the
tiredness itself gets read as motion — so you keep
going for years.

Second: "Busy" is the most dangerous word in your life

That word has become the official answer to "how are
you?". It's said verbatim by everyone to everyone, and
few notice that it's not an answer... it's a flight from an
answer.

Run this test on the last week of your life, hour by
hour:

- The 8 hours of work: "where is this taking me?"
- The three hours on the phone at night: "going
where?"
- The gatherings and side jobs: "going where?"

If most of the answers come down to: "so the day
passes" — then you're running in neutral: an engine
with a loud sound and moving energy... and not a
single centimetre moved.

And notice an important distinction before you get sad: being busy itself isn't the disease. Work is honour, and responsibility is nobility. The disease is when "the day passes" becomes the destination. That's why the difference isn't between one salary and another, or one job and another: there are people with modest income walking a clear direction, and people with big income stuck in the same year for years. The meter doesn't ask about the balance... it asks about the direction.

Third: People's destination isn't yours

The most dangerous thing about destination is that it's inherited.

Your father: "become a doctor or an engineer." The group: "this course is in demand in the market." Your friend: "come, let's start a project." Social media: "everyone travels, be aware." And you follow all of it with real seriousness and effort... and every time you arrive you feel something's missing. Not because you're a failure — because the ladder is solid and sturdy... but it's leaning on a wall that isn't yours. And you wonder why the summit felt hollow: you climbed the ladder... but it wasn't on the wall you wanted.

There's one question that tells a borrowed destination from a real one. Ask yourself about any goal you have:

"If no one would ever know... and no one would ever see... would I still want it?"

If the answer changes the moment you take people out of the equation — then it was someone else's destination, left with you as a trust. And if it stays fixed — then it's yours, and you can spend your life on it with peace of mind.

And here a dangerous carryover from Part One works behind the scenes: "your mind believes what gets repeated." If you think every day about someone else's goal, your mind will be programmed on it and you'll feel it's truly yours. And you'll discover the truth later — on the day you feel your life is missing something while you're standing in the middle of it not understanding why. That's why this check is done now... not after the road.

Fourth: A destination is a year long... not a whole life

The biggest trap in the "where to?" question: believing you must know the map of your whole life before you move a step. So you choke on the size of the question, so you postpone, so you say "it's still early for this kind of thinking."

No. No one knows the map of their life — not even the author himself. You don't need a life map... you

need a **one-year destination**. A year is something you can see: twelve months, fifty-two weeks. And it's set with one question:

"What do I want to be different in my life after 365 days?"

Not "I'll become a millionaire" — decorative dreams turn into pressure. Something you can genuinely picture: a certificate you got and entered a field with. A skill that became a small income source. A body that got in shape. One project that stood up. A mental state different from last year.

And after the destination... no grand plans or Excel files. There's **the step of the day**: a small thing that takes a minute, that you do today, and moves you a centimetre toward it. It's the same One-Minute Rule you learned in Part One — but the second version of its mission: there it was breaking procrastination... here it's gaining distance. Every day you push one in its direction, or you push it into the sack. And that sack is called a life.

Chapter Exercise: The Destination Page

What you need: a sheet of paper, a pen, and one quiet fifteen minutes. And your phone far from you — not off, just far.

1. **At the very top of the page write:** "A year from today... I am:"

2. **Complete the sentence three times only.** Three full sentences — not words: one about your body or health, one about your work or income, one about your state or relationships. If more than three come, don't write any but the three that remain with you after an hour.

3. **Choose one.** If you're torn between two, ask: "If I had only one year... which one would I not let go?" The one you wouldn't let go — that's the destination.

4. **Write the appearance line.** Not the dream itself — its daily effect. Not "I'll be rich"... "I'll wake up without the bill keeping me up in my head." Not "I'll be famous"... "I'll work on something I'm proud to show my daughter when she grows up."

5. **Write the step of the day.** The smallest step, one minute long, that you do before you sleep tonight. Not tomorrow. Tonight.

6. **And the page in a fixed place in front of you.** A destination that's written and hidden... gets lost.

And four common traps:

- **"I can't find anything to dream of":** Start from the one thing that bothers you in your life right now. Half

the world's destinations were born from the line "I don't want this anymore" — start from it and fold it to the other side.

- **"It has to be big or nothing":** A small one-year destination that got harvested beats a postponed life dream. A big dream burns on its own... a small destination gets harvested alongside others.

- **"I'm not free right now":** Those fifteen minutes are the time of three videos. If there's no quarter of an hour for your year, then the question "where to" has found its real answer.

- **"I'll start at the beginning of the month":** A destination that waits for the first of the month... waits for the new year, and then for a whole life. Those fifteen minutes exist today, exactly.

The mark of success: It's not enthusiasm. Enthusiasm is a guest who comes and goes like all guests. The mark of success is something far quieter: as you read the three sentences, one of them will do something strange in your chest. Not a flutter... something like "this one's mine." If you felt it in one of them — then this page is the first page of your life written without inheritance. And hold on to that feeling... you'll need it in the next chapter.

Sentence of the Week

"Busy... doesn't mean moving."

Write it on your phone and put it in front of you at the desk. All week, every time you hear yourself say "I'm busy" — or hear it from someone — stop for a second and ask: "Busy with what? Going where?" Even if the answer is "I don't know" — the stopping itself is the first answer in the chain. Because who never stops... never defines. And everything that starts from an honest stop... gets a direction.

Before We Close the Chapter...

Karim didn't get a miracle at the station. He went home, slept, and woke the next day to the same routine. But one small thing changed: the question stayed with him. In transport, at the office, in the face in the mirror. And after three weeks, he wrote the first destination page of his life — something no one would guess: a certificate in financial analysis he'd been saying "I'll do it" to for fourteen years. Not because it's his life's dream... because it was the first thing he found the line "this one's mine" in, without thinking of anyone.

His meter still counts like before. But the difference became clear to him alone: every hour now counts in a direction.

And with that — let me hand you the question that should stay with you for the rest of the week:

Karim needed a coincidence at a petrol station for the question to reach him. You have this chapter — so the question has reached you. But to be honest with you as usual: the question is the easy part of the story. The hard part is what comes after — what separates someone who wrote a destination page and threw it in the drawer... from someone who wrote it and walked behind it.

There's a thing called **a decision**. Not just any decision — the decision that's taken once, costs on its day, and pays its price while you're alone in front of the mirror. There's one night in every life that splits time in two: before it and after it. And the next chapter is about that night exactly — and about the frame that lets a decision stay standing no matter how the storms hit:

"One decision that changes the direction."

Chapter Two: One Decision That Changes the Direction

In Part One we talked about a moment called "the shock": the moment you see yourself as you truly are. And in the last chapter we talked about "the destination page": the moment you define where you're going.

But there's a third moment... the hardest and most honourable of them. And its shape is strange: **a night.**

Not just any night. A night where you're alone, the notebooks lined up in front of you, the world quiet. A night where you make one decision... and never go back on it. The night that splits your life in two: before it and after it.

People call it "the moment of inspiration" — and that's a beautiful name for the surface of the thing. The truth is quieter and deeper: a decision that holds isn't a coincidence or enthusiasm. **It has an engineering.** And this chapter is about that engineering: how your mind makes a decision exactly... and how you make a decision you never turn back from.

Tarek's Story, and the Kitchen Night

Tarek is thirty-six. An accountant at a pharmaceutical company, a father of three, a calm man with an organized life. There's one thing only that was never organized: the cigarette. Since he was nineteen — seventeen full years of smoking.

He tried to quit **seven times in ten years**. Seven official attempts, each with a date and an intention: the start of the year, his birthday, the day his older daughter coughed in his face. And every time the same film: three days of enthusiasm... day four "just one, last one"... day seven full relapse, and a feeling of guilt worse than anything.

The story closed on a night of symptoms. A strange tightness in his chest. First: shortness of breath. Tarek climbed the third floor of his house and stopped, exposed to himself: his heart pounding in his ear. At thirty-six, that wasn't on.

That night, while washing his face in front of the mirror, he looked at the number he'd been avoiding for years: seventeen years of smoke. And the mirror — like any mirror — was final: it showed him the whole bill.

But this time there was no enthusiasm. No motivational music, no videos, no ringing words. There

was something quieter and more dangerous: **a sheet of paper and a pen.** Tarek sat at the kitchen table at one in the morning and did the math he'd never done in the last ten years — not flattering himself:

- If I stay as I am for another ten years: twenty cigarettes a day $\times$ 3,650 days = **73,000 cigarettes.** Not a number... that's a rope.

- And if I stop today: what's the worst scene I'll bear in the first 90 days? The irritability, the sleep loss, the friends who'll turn on me.

And he wrote the last line as he closed the pen on the paper: "I'm quitting. **Not trying...** quitting." And he signed under it with tonight's date. Then he got up and threw every lighter and cigarette in the house into the bin... before he slept.

Seven attempts in ten years. The eighth night... five years without a single cigarette, up to the moment you're reading this line.

And the difference between the eighth night and the seven before it isn't willpower — Tarek himself swears it to you: the night of the decision he was weaker than on any day of the attempts. The difference was one thing: **the way the decision itself was taken.** The seven before were "an attempt." That night was "a

decision." And those are two completely different things... and our whole chapter is about the difference between them.

How Your Mind Makes a Decision Exactly

First: Your mind isn't a balance of hope... it's a balance of pain

The first chapter said your mind is the greatest navigation system ever born. Add to that one more: that system's whole work is **a trade-off**. Every decision in the world — even one that looks like a burst of enthusiasm — is taken by an equation as old as humanity itself:

The mind moves when the pain of standing exceeds the pain of changing.

As long as you're standing in relative comfort, the mind sees "going back to normal" as the cheaper option. That's why most big decisions come after shocks: illness, loss, a fall, a stand in front of a mirror. Not because grief inspires... because the bill actually changed — the price of standing became exposed.

And Tarek: the seven attempts were built on hope ("my health will improve, I'll look better"). And hope's price is flexible — it gets renegotiated every night before sleep. But the kitchen night wrote the pain bill in the

open, in numbers: "every extra year of my life at its full price." The moment the page turned from hope to pain... the mind adjusted the balance that same night.

Second: A decision isn't a feeling... a decision = a door closed

The common understanding is that a decision is a moment of loud voice and pounding heart. The truth is the opposite: a real decision has a strange quiet. Because its definition isn't "I chose something"... its definition is: **I closed a door.**

There's a revealing test: if you wrote on your page "I'll beat procrastination," and then every day you keep asking yourself from inside "do I continue or not?" — then you haven't made a decision. You have **an open proposal** to yourself. A real decision means the question "whether?" has been lifted from the equation entirely, and there's only one question left on the table: "how?".

And that's the kindest thing you can do for your mind in your whole life. Cast your mind back to Part One: every open question takes space in the background, and the open question "do I continue?" recharges every day. A decision settles it once and locks it... and the energy that was burning on tallying gets freed and goes to the work itself. The people you call "stubborn" reach

faster than others not because they're stronger — because they never reopen a closed file.

Third: Hesitation isn't weakness... it's an incomplete bill

If you've been hesitating for years over a decision, you're not weak or a failure — you're just standing in front of an incomplete equation. The mind never refuses a move for no reason... it refuses a move **with no clear difference**. When the alternatives look alike, and the balance is unclear, hesitation is perfectly natural. And the solution isn't "stronger will"... the solution is completing the bill: writing the price of each alternative in numbers. The moment the differences land on paper, hesitation burns on its own.

And a more dangerous point comes from Part One: "your mind believes what gets repeated." A full year of "I'll start tomorrow" turns, by repetition, into an implicit decision: "I can't." The decision you don't take... **gets taken for you. Against you**. So your life isn't standing still as you think — it's genuinely moving, in the direction of the decision you chose to flee from.

Fourth: After every decision comes "the dry point"... and whoever continues isn't stronger, just expected it

The most dangerous piece of information in this chapter: most people who go back on a real decision fall not on the day of the decision. That day is full of energy and lift. What burns decisions is another day entirely — after two or three weeks: **the dry point**.

The day enthusiasm leaves you alone, the result hasn't shown yet, and life goes back to normal as if nothing happened. And the quiet, scary sentence arrives: "or what... rest a bit. There's no difference."

Whoever goes back isn't weaker than whoever continues. The only difference: whoever continues knew this day was coming before he took his decision... and prepared two things for it:

- **The page had a fixed place.** The moment the voice comes, he returns to the written bill... not to argue with the voice. The voice always wins the argument, and the page always wins.
- **The One-Minute Rule.** On the dry day you don't need to commit to the whole dream — you need one minute only in its direction. That minute doesn't add progress... **it preserves the direction** until the dry point passes. And it passes.

Chapter Exercise: The Night of the Decision

What you need: one night only of your life, a sheet of paper, a pen, and your phone far away. Thirty minutes maximum. And the hardest condition: **one decision.**

1. **Define the one decision.** If you find yourself writing a list of "next-phase decisions" — stop. That list is a plan, not a decision. Tonight is for one only. And the mark that you've chosen right: it's the decision you've been fleeing from the longest... the one taking the most from you.

2. **Write the standing bill in numbers.** If you stayed standing as you are **a full year:** what does your health pay? Your pocket? Your time? Your relationships? Honest numbers even if they hurt — that's the bill your mind calculates every day without looking at it.

3. **Write the change bill honestly.** The price of the first 90 days: the strain, how you look in front of people, the tiredness. If you write "there's no price" — then you're still dreaming, not deciding.

4. **Write the decision sentence in a closed form.** Forbidden: "I'll try," "God willing if," "we'll see." Allowed only: "I + verb" or "I don't + verb." Like Tarek: "I'm quitting."

5. Sign and write the date. The signature isn't a drawing... it's a contract. And contracts get executed.

6. Pay the first bill before you sleep. A small tangible step that actually closes the door: Tarek threw out the lighters. The project owner sent the first message to a potential client. The student registered in the course. The small step today is what turns the page from feeling into a transaction.

And four common traps:

- **"I'll decide when I feel ready":** The error is inverted — readiness comes after the decision, not before it.
- **"The bigger decision is better":** one small decision executed is richer than twenty big ones on the page.
- **"I know myself, I won't stick":** That's not a prediction, that's an announcement. A prediction is written in numbers before the event... not in feelings after it.
- **"Afraid to announce and fail":** The decision isn't an announcement to people — it's a contract with yourself. No one needs to know but the page... and the closest people, if you want.

The mark of success: Not tears and not euphoria. The mark of success is that after you signed, you felt a

strange quiet. Don't fear it — it's the sound of the door as it closes.

Sentence of the Week

"I tried... doesn't mean I decided."

Write it and put it in front of you. All week, every time you hear yourself or someone say "I tried a lot and there's no use" — stop a second and ask: "Tried... or decided?" Because that answer governs everything that's coming: whoever tries has seven attempts coming. And whoever makes a decision... has one night.

Before We Close the Chapter...

Tarek is now forty-one. Five years without a single cigarette — but the story is nicer than that: the man who used to break his decisions one after another became a one-decision man. In his work, in his home, in how he eats. Because a decision doesn't change only the thing you made it for — **it builds a muscle**. And the decision muscle is like any muscle: once it stands up right once, the next stand is easier.

But let me be honest with you as usual: the decision isn't the end of the story. It's the moment of take-off...

and after take-off comes the part that drops most planes: **the wait.**

The stretch between the day of planting and the day the first thing sprouts. There's no result to look at in it, and an inner voice saying "there's no use." There's a thing that runs in your mind in this silence... whoever knows it passes without falling.

People call it patience. And I'll tell you in the next chapter why patience isn't waiting... **patience is continuation.**

Chapter Three: Patience Isn't Waiting — Patience Is Continuation

The last chapter took us to the decision: a page, a signature, a closed door. And after take-off... comes the longest part of any road: **the silence.**

Not success at once, and not failure at once. Silence. A stretch where you work every day, and no one applauds... and no number tells you "you're moving." And it's the stretch that drops more people from the road than failure itself drops them. Not because the decision was wrong — because no one told us that **this gap is part of the equation, not a sign it failed.**

We'll begin the way we always begin... with a story.

Dalia's Story, and the Six Dead Months

Dalia is twenty-nine. An Arabic-language teacher at a primary school. Her salary brings the end of the month's work... like everything else. And one night — after a destination page like the one we did in the first chapter — she took her one decision in the closed form: "I'm learning graphic design. Ninety minutes every night."

First month: enthusiasm and lift. Second month: the lessons got harder, and her work started to look ugly next to the professionals'. Third month: the dreaded question arrived... "So where's the money? Where are the clients?"

A blunt tally: 150 nights $\times$ 90 minutes = **more than 225 hours of learning**. And the visible yield: zero clients. Zero pounds. And a phone that hadn't rung in months.

Dalia had set one condition on herself: six full months — 180 nights — before any verdict. And the night of the dreaded reckoning was **night 143**. She turned off the light and said: "Tomorrow I continue." Knowing that tomorrow could bring an uglier feeling: "Last night is proof... I'm wasting my time."

What saved the story was an ordinary call the day after. Uncle Fathy. Her grandfather. A farmer from Menoufia, who never went to school, and who knows about the land what none of them know. Dalia told him with a heavy laugh: "Uncle Fathy... I've been planting for five months and nothing has come up."

Uncle Fathy answered without thinking twice:

"Dalia... the seed stays under the ground for thirty days before anyone sees anything of it. Whoever rushes

reaches in to dig in the mud to look for it — **he tears the roots while they're already growing.** The land never betrays the one who waters it... but it doesn't hurry for anyone."

The world stopped in Dalia's ears. She'd been doing exactly what Uncle Fathy was describing: opening the sales number every day, counting followers, turning over the dirt to look for the sprout. Meaning she was killing the harvest with her own hand... while wishing for it.

This time she changed the balance, not the goal. She left the clients number, and hung another page next to it: **the watering page.** Every night 90 minutes of learning = a mark. Every finished piece = a mark. Every work she published = a mark. And under the title, one line: "First 90 days: counting the watering only. The harvest is forbidden from the count."

From night 143 to 180: 37 nights of watering without a single question. The portfolio reached piece number forty. And the first real client message arrived **on day 168** — twelve nights only before the verdict date she'd set in the first place.

And to the people around her: "What a day! Dalia became a designer all of a sudden!" — all of a sudden. In one day. None of them ever saw the 180 nights.

And this story isn't a story of luck or a universe rewarding the patient. The story is simpler and harder: whoever continues stays on the table until the gap opens. **Staying in the game is ninety percent of the game.** And this chapter is about how to cross the longest part of it.

What's Happening Inside Your Mind in the Gap

First: Your mind is a reward counter... and in the gap no counter fires

From Part One you learned that your mind is a reward system: it loves the close, small reward, and it works for it. The problem is the gap is a long stretch with not a single visible reward in it. The technical result: any move without a reward the mind logs as "temporary failure"... and accumulated temporary failure turns in your feeling into one sentence: "there's no use."

But that log is an operational error, not a true verdict: **absence of evidence isn't evidence of absence.** No visible result $\neq$ nothing's happening. And what's happening in the gap is genuinely real... but it's happening somewhere you're not looking. And it's here:

Second: Everything that grows... builds its roots underground first

Before any stalk rises above the dirt, a root walks under the dirt. The longest stage in the growth of anything — a skill, a project, a body, a relationship — is the root stage: information sorts itself, the hand trains, experience accumulates. And none of that shows in the mirror or in the numbers.

And the real danger in the gap isn't boredom — the danger is that you look every day: count the result, turn over the dirt, search for the sprout. And every turn breaks hairs of real roots that got made. That's why this chapter comes with a clear rule of forbidden things: **let the dirt settle**. Measurement is required... but in its right place, and we'll reach it in the exercise.

Third: Patience isn't waiting... patience is continuation without proof

This is the heart of the chapter. The word itself got distorted: people understood patience as keeping quiet, bearing it, and standing still waiting for the result to come to me. And if that's your patience... you're not patient, you're suspended.

See what the farmer does in the stretch between planting and harvest: he waters. He weeds. He prays. He prunes. Meaning: **he's not standing still at all**.

The harvest isn't an act done on the day of the sickle... the harvest is a passive noun for a set of waterings. The difference between who harvests and who hangs isn't in the land or the seed — it's in the work done in the silence.

So the right definition: **patience is continuation without visible proof.** The waiter puts his life on hold until the result comes. The patient one waters and walks on. And why does he win in the end? Because he's the only one still there when the gap opens.

Fourth: Growth isn't a straight line... it's steps and jumps

One last truth about the gap: growth isn't a line that walks at a steady slope every day. Growth is silent accumulation... and suddenly a step rises: the first client, the first acceptance, the first real difference in the mirror. From outside it looks like "a miracle" or "good luck." From inside it's a night out of 180 nights stacked on top of each other.

That's why most of the world's successes get described as "happened in one day" — because people never saw the nights. And you don't need to look at someone who came up in a day; you need to know one truth: that one day is a house wired to a hundred and eighty

nights of electricity... and you hold that wire in your hand.

Chapter Exercise: The Watering Page

What you need: a sheet of paper, a pen, and a fixed place for it. And this exercise isn't for a night — it's the system of the whole next month.

1. **At the top of the page write the expected harvest in one line.** That's your destination from the first chapter's page — meaning the two pages must be next to each other.
2. **Translate the harvest into a daily centimetre.** The smallest unit of work you do every day and count: a minute of learning, a page, a piece, a call, a drill. The only condition: something you can put a mark on — **an act, not an intention.**
3. **Draw 30 boxes.** Every day of watering = an X mark. Done. The gap has become a numbers page instead of a muffled feeling.
4. **The lock rule: in the first 90 days the harvest is forbidden from the count entirely.** Early numbers always lie — any feeling built on them is taken on noise. The only count allowed: the number of X marks.

5. **The day that passes:** forbidden "the week's lost." Tomorrow two centimetres and carry on — a small make-up, not a collapse. The One-Minute Rule works here in its purest form.

6. **At the end of the month, count only the X's.** A month with 25 marks = a successful month even if the harvest is still zero. You're building the watering muscle... and that's the muscle that matters.

And four common traps:

- **"I have to see a result every day to keep motivated":** That's exactly the digging in the dirt. The motivation has moved to the X mark... not to the sprout.
- **"People arrive faster":** Whoever waters on his page never looks at anyone — his feeling of comparison drowns amid his own real numbers.
- **"I don't feel any progress":** Not because there's no progress — because you're looking above the dirt... and all the progress is underneath.
- **"I'll continue without a page, I'll remember":** A decision that lived only in your mind burns up at the first dryness. The page is a contract... and the mind respects written contracts more than intentions.

The mark of success: Mid-month you'll find yourself making the mark without deciding it. Watering has become part of your day like a cup of coffee — not a task to be negotiated. And right there the gap has lost its only weapon: that it demoralizes you.

Sentence of the Week

"I waited... doesn't mean I was patient."

Write it and put it in front of you. All week, every time you feel "I'm being patient with the result" — ask yourself the revealing question: "Patient meaning waiting... or watering?" The waiter has never harvested anything in the history of the earth. The planter is the one who harvests — even if he's the last to see the harvest.

Before We Close the Chapter...

Dalia is now thirty-one. Design became the second half of her income, and the portfolio speaks for her in places she's not even present in. And Uncle Fathy's sentence hangs in a small frame above her desk at the school, written in his own hand: "The land never betrays the one who waters it."

But before we close, let me carry on with you the honesty I promised: silence isn't the most the gap does.

There comes a day when a **storm** arrives: an obvious failure, a real loss, a fall in front of people — a day when your inner voice hits zero. And on that day the question isn't "do I continue or not"... the question is: "who was I before the storm came?"

Your habits, the ones you built in the silence, get tested not on the quiet days — in storm time. And the next chapter is about the black day: what happens to you under pressure... and how you come back at the smallest possible degree — without breaking the whole leg.

"Storm Time."

Chapter Four: Storm Time

The last chapter was about silence — the gap where there's no sound. This chapter is about **the noise**.

There's a day in every road when a loud sound comes. You don't hear it... you feel it. A day when you feel the ground you're standing on is shaking. And not every storm comes with thunder: there's a storm called a **result**. An exam result, a client's rejection, a medical report, a loss of money, people's talk. The night the numbers say "no" to you — and you were sure they'd say "yes."

And on that day no philosophy works. There's only the answer to one question that determines everything that happens after the storm:

"Who were you before it came?"

We'll begin the way we always begin... with a story.

Mona's Story, and the Broken Month

Mona is thirty-three. A pharmacist in Nasr City. And a system owner — not enthusiasm: a half-hour walk every morning before work, measured eating, early sleep. Across fourteen months the result was clear: she dropped **20 kilos** on the scale — and with them

weights dropped from her soul too. She had what many people wish for: a working system. A calibrated engine... not a charge of enthusiasm.

The storm came without asking permission, like all storms: the phone at two in the morning. Her mother. A heart crisis. The hospital.

Mona spent the next month shuttling between the pharmacy, the hospital, and home — and the system? The system shattered. Food became anything on any corner. The walk? Stopped. Sleep? On a chair beside the bed. And I'm not joking when I tell you: that's **natural** — and it's the mind's job in danger: it shuts down everything non-essential, and pours all the energy into survival. And the mother today matters more than the diet by forty light-years.

So the problem isn't that month. The problem began the first Saturday after her mother left the hospital.

Mona sat and wrote the return plan: **a full return.** Saturday: half-hour walk, measured food, sleep at 11. And the result? That Saturday saw three attempts at full return... and all three failed. Why? Because a half-hour walk after a month of travel and nursing a sick person... tired her for a full hour, and her mind was still in the hospital even while she walked in the street.

And after every failed attempt she'd write in the notebook in her head the line: "I know I'm weak." — and after three weeks of those attempts, her inner voice had become harsher than the storm itself. And the number that went up on the scale: **7 kilos came back.**

The story closed on a small scene in another hospital — a follow-up appointment for her mother. The doctor was telling her mother about the rehab programme: "The heart after surgery never goes back to running from day one. First week: walk only to the bedroom door. Then to the end of the stairs. And so on."

Mona was standing at the door listening... and heard the sentence a second time, but this time for herself: **the heart after a storm never returns full from the first day.** It needs the smallest degree.

She went home and took the full-return plan... and cut it up. And hung a new page in its place: **the smallest-degree plan.** First week: five minutes of walking only. Five. Second week: ten. Third: fifteen. And after a month and a half she was walking a half hour again — and the seven kilos that came in... left again, without anyone noticing.

What Happens to You During Storms

First: Under pressure... your mind goes to the oldest, not the strongest

In storm time, the last thing working is the new habits. Why? Because the mind in danger shuts down the expensive systems... and goes back to the oldest, cheapest programming. And that's the same idea we saw in the first chapter: fire-fighting mode. In danger you are not you — you're the old version of you.

So the first question after the storm isn't "why did I break?". That's the wrong question — you broke because that's natural. The right question: **"What's the smallest thing in my old system that brings the working part back?"**

Second: The biggest trap in returning... the "all or nothing" trap

Most people, after the first fall, try to return with the same version they had before the fall: 100% from day one. And that's the dumbest strategic move you can make — forgive the word, but it really is: you're asking a body and mind still coming out of danger... to play a full match. And the result is inevitable: the attempt fails.

And the catastrophe isn't that the attempt failed. The catastrophe is that this failure gets translated in your inner notebook: "See? I'm weak." — and that's perjured testimony: you didn't test yourself at all... you tested the impossible. No one brings 100% on the first day after a storm — those who do are either lying to you... or to themselves.

Third: The Smallest-Degree Rule — the second version of the One-Minute Rule

In Part One we took the One-Minute Rule to break procrastination. And here we take it with a new mission: **returning after the break**. And the difference matters a lot: in procrastination, the minute was breaking the psychological barrier. In return, the minute does something far deeper:

It brings the identity back.

The point isn't that the five minutes burn calories — the point is that on this day Mona went back to being "someone who walks." Because behaviour isn't only the result of identity... behaviour is what re-casts the vote for identity: "I'm still me." Every day a smallest degree = an internal ballot saying: the new version is still in office. And the identity that voted for you... never waits for mood.

Fourth: The fall is an event... not an identity

The most dangerous thing in storms isn't the fall itself — **the interpretation you take about yourself afterward**. There's a difference between two sentences:

- "I fell" — a description of an event.
- "I'm someone who falls" — a verdict on identity.

And the mind — as we knew in Part One — believes what gets repeated. If the interpretation becomes a verdict, it starts building a whole life on it. That's why let me say it clearly: self-compassion isn't softness or surrender — **self-compassion is a return strategy**. Whoever punishes himself for the fall never closes the account... he lengthens the stand. And whoever says "a thing happened. Done. I continue at the smallest degree" — that's not soft... that's the fastest way back to standing.

Chapter Exercise: The Return-Day Plan

This exercise is a bit strange from the ones before it: you don't do it during the storm... **you do it today** — and the page works on its own when its time comes.

1. **Write the 3 most important habits in your current system.** The ones you're building now — the watering of the month's page.

2. **Next to each, write its "smallest degree."** A one-minute version of the same act — not a different act: half-hour walk → five minutes. Ten pages → one page. An hour of study → five minutes of review.

3. **Name the page "Return Day"** and put it next to the watering page in the fixed place.

4. **When the storm comes — and it will:** the first 7 days no full-return decision is allowed. The only decision permitted: the smallest degree.

5. **From the second week:** add one degree only.

6. **And write on the same page the sentence allowed then:** "This fall is a result... not an identity."

And four common traps:

- **"I lost this month... so I lost the year":** A phantom tally — 30 flat days don't cancel the 300 that came before them. The farmer whose land a storm hit... plants again, he doesn't sell the land.
- **"I have to punish myself a bit to know":** Self-punishment isn't strength — it's the slowest method of delay in existence, but it's labelled "motivation."
- **"I'll return when my mood comes":** Mood comes after the return... not before it. A mood to walk will never reach you while you're still not walking.

- **"This system broke once... so it'll never settle":**

The system that broke once became weak? No — it became **tested**. And that's a promotion, not an insult.

The mark of success: Not the speed of your return — your return itself. The first day of return that actually happened, even if it was five minutes... then you've won the whole battle. Because the first return was never about speed — about restarting the right version of you.

Sentence of the Week

"I fell... doesn't mean I'm done."

Write it and put it in front of you. All week, every time you want to punish yourself for a fall — stop a second and apply the sentence: the fall is an event, not an identity. And that event has a first degree of return... waiting for you written on the Return-Day page, ready before you need it.

Before We Close the Chapter...

Mona now, a year after the storm: her mother is well — on her programme, and once a week they walk a half hour together on the outing: the mother on the doctor's programme... and Mona on her road. And the seven kilos that came in during the broken month left

without anyone noticing. And the difference between her and who she was: the system has become a **tested** system — it knows what storms look like... and knows the degree of the first step after them.

But let me reveal to you the last secret of the storm chapter: you never cross it alone.

The storm reveals, without you looking at anything else at all: **who's around you**. In ease, all people are sweet and smiling. In the storm the real measures happen: there's the one who'll take your hand... and the one who'll say "I told you from the start." And the next chapter is about exactly that difference: the people who charge you and the people who drain you... and how you choose who's around you before you choose the road itself.

"Who's Around You?"

Chapter Five: Who's Around You?

In the chapters past we worked on the world from the inside: the destination, the decision, the patience, the storms. This chapter is about the last secret of the story — and the first secret in it:

You never cross this road alone.

You've judged your case from your mind and your system... but there's something stronger than both, working in the background without ever asking your permission: **the people around you.**

We'll begin the way we always begin... with a story.

Omar's Story, and the Thursday Gathering

Omar is twenty-seven. A civil engineer at a consultancy. And he has a clear dream like the destination page we've been talking about since the first chapter: a new skill by night — web development — that flips him an income after a year. His system: six hours of learning a week, at night, after work.

And there's one other thing in his life as old as the dream: **the Thursday gathering.** The high-school crowd — every Thursday from nine at night to two in the morning. A genuinely good gathering: football,

cards, memories. Omar loves them and they love him — and that's the most important sentence in this chapter, so hold it in your awareness.

The problem is the gathering had an opinion about the dream. Every time Omar opened the topic: "Man! You think you're Zuckerberg?" and a general laugh, and the topic gets thrown behind the gathering. No one hates him... but something moves without anyone intending it.

When Omar counted it in numbers, he found something stunning:

- The gathering: five hours every Thursday $\times$ 52 weeks = **260 hours a year.**
- And the course he needs for his dream: **240 hours.**

The gathering he loves... eats his whole dream and has 20 hours left over.

The storm — as we agreed in the last chapter, comes without asking permission — came this time as a layoff at the firm. Omar left the job in one day. The gathering gave its opinion the same day in the group chat:

"Rejoice, man! The whole system is corrupt. Come sit with us... whatever God has, He gives him."

And on that same day exactly, a message came from a completely different kind of people. Khaled — an old

friend, not from the crowd, who writes to him from time to time and asks about his road seriously. The message: "I heard the news. I'm taking on a project the whole of next month and I don't have a developer... the code isn't urgent. Come, I'll see you tomorrow morning."

Look at the difference: some people told him **"sit"...** and some told him **"come."**

Omar went back to the numbers again, but this time not on the gathering's hours — on the direction's budget. He made an arrangement decision, not a cut: the gathering became once a month, not every Thursday. And the six learning hours got extended. And Khaled became a weekly sitting. And after a year... Omar's first real client for his project came from these night projects.

What People Do to You Without You Feeling It

First: You're the average of the five people you spend your time with — a tally, not wisdom

Your mind is a simulation device: it learns by observation before experience. One guy complains in every gathering? After a month you're complaining without a clear reason. Someone sees the world as

bleak? Your feeling gets adjusted without you taking a decision.

And that's not emotional talk — it's a tally: the five people who take your time are five private tutors you're not paying money... you're paying them time. And time is what fattens them: those who sit with you most... teach into you most.

Second: Whoever pulls you doesn't hate you... they love an old version of you

The hardest truth in this chapter. Pulling rarely comes dressed as hatred — most who pull you **love you**. But they apply that love to an old version of you: you like them, your sitting is their place, your ambition is postponed like theirs. The moment you try to move, it looks to them like you're leaving them... so they work automatically on returning you to the comfortable spot.

Like the crabs in the bucket: one tries to climb out, and the rest pull him down — not because they hate him. Because if one gets out, then the rest have admitted that the bucket isn't a place to sit. **Pull is mostly fear... wearing the clothes of love.**

And this understanding doesn't exempt anyone from their effect — it helps you handle it without cruelty: you're not cutting hearts... you're adjusting doses.

Third: The charger isn't the one who says "bravo"... it's the one who asks "where have you reached?"

A fine and dangerous difference. Empty praise rests you — and rest is the drainer's top wish. But the question by name — "did you finish the second part of the course?" — is something else entirely: someone is logging your arrival.

Marks of the real charger:

- Asks about your project **by name**... not about your general state.
- Tells you "I did such-and-such" — so he charges you with example, not advice.
- In storm time he moves with an act... not verbal consolation.
- After you sit with him, you feel you have **more energy**... not less.

And the final test: the charging gathering leaves fuel in you. The draining one draws from your battery without you noticing.

Fourth: It's not a cut... it's a dose arrangement

The mind is a social creature — total isolation is a punishment, not a solution. And total immersion in those gatherings is your dream being eaten in instalments. The solution that actually works, in a clear half: **the ratios.**

Reduce the dose of the drainers... and increase the dose of the chargers. One charging gathering a week is stronger than five entertainment ones. And the golden rule: who doesn't choose their circle by hand... will have their days arranged for them without them feeling it.

Chapter Exercise: The Five Tally

What you need: a page, a quiet hour, and a dose of honesty with yourself — because this exercise opens doors that deserve opening.

- 1. Write the five people who take the biggest time from your week.** Not the people you love most... the people most present in your life. Honesty here is hard and required.
- 2. Estimate the hours:** next to each one, write the weekly hours approximately.

3. **Mark next to each one:** charger / drainer / neutral — by the marks of the chapter above, not by the momentary feeling.

4. **Write the chargers list.** If only one name ends up on it — that's fine, and start looking for another: a professional group, someone on a road you like, one monthly gathering.

5. **The dose decision:** for the drainers — no sudden cut. One decision only: reduce the appointments or reduce the duration. (Omar reduced the appointments from four a month to one.)

6. **Add a new charger this month:** a message, a gathering, a group subscription — anything that adds a dose of fuel.

And four common traps:

- **"They're my friends from way back":** Duration isn't a measure... direction is the measure. The only question: after the gathering, are you charged or tired?
- **"I'm strong, it doesn't affect me":** Social habit is stronger than any individual will — and your mind imitates while asleep.
- **"I'll cut them all and continue alone":** An emotional reaction — after two weeks it relapses worse, and loses the innocent neutrals with it.

- **"I can't find chargers around me":** The charger doesn't have to be close: a channel that charges, a book, a group with your direction. The important thing is that the phenomenon you sit with... charges.

The mark of success: After the first month of arranging the doses, look at your energy budget: you sit with people and rise feeling you've **grown a bit...** not shrunk. That's the only indicator.

Sentence of the Week

"I sat with them... doesn't mean I'm going with them."

Write it and put it in front of you. All week, in every gathering, ask yourself the first chapter's question anew: "Where's this gathering going?" If it's not in the direction of your destination — that's fine, take your dose and walk on... but take the dose by your own hand, not by the order of appointments.

Before We Close the Chapter...

Omar now, a year in: the gathering is still there — once a month, they joke and laugh exactly like before. But the difference became clear to him alone: the gathering has become a rest station... not an arrival station. The moment he rises, he continues his road.

Up to this point in the book we've worked on the best version of you: a clear destination, a closed decision, watering patience, and a return at the smallest degree, and arranging the people around you. But one last question remains — and the most beautiful of them all:

This power... **whom will it serve?**

Because there's a dangerous difference between someone strong... and someone strong with a reason to exist. And the next chapter is about the moment Power of Mind crosses your own limits — when what you planted in yourself starts to bear fruit in other people's lives. The next chapter is the spirit of *Khidmaty* all of it... and it's the part the whole book was made for:

"Your Power, in Service of Whom?"

Chapter Six: Your Power, in Service of Whom?

Let's gather all the threads of the book in one hand: you knew where you're going (destination), you closed a door (decision), you watered every day (patience), you returned at the smallest degree after every storm, and you arranged the people around you.

Which means you are now — by the technical measure — **a strong person.**

But let me ask you a question no one dares ask until they collide with it: strong... for whom?

Because there comes a moment in everyone's life that has no name in the books — a moment that reaches you alone. A moment where you feel that everything you've built... is good, and ordered, and walking — but something is missing no matter how much you add. And this chapter is about exactly that thing: the thing that isn't bought... **meaning.**

We'll begin the way we always begin... with a story.

Mostafa's Story, and the Broken Ceiling

Mostafa is in his thirties. He owns a phone repair workshop in a popular neighbourhood. This workshop

isn't a passing dream — it's the result of fourteen years of work: seven years working for someone else, three years of loan and installments, the gap years we talked about... and the year of the storm when the world hit and he learned to return at the smallest degree. The workshop is called «Mostafa Service» — by his name. Just as he dreamed, exactly, when he was sixteen.

Mostafa arrived. The income became good, the name became known in the neighbourhood, and the goal that was drawn on a destination page years ago became a reality that had been stable for three years.

And after he arrived... the strange thing happened.

One Friday, sitting at the café alone, he felt something that has no name in his dictionary: the workshop is running, the money is running... and every day became a repeated copy of the one before it: opening, repair, closing, money counted in the notebook. The power he was gathering for a goal... found its goal... and walked off. **The ceiling — he reached it... and the ceiling is a tight place.**

The story closed at Madame Zeinab.

A woman in her sixties, living in the building whose ground floor holds Mostafa's workshop. She came into the shop one afternoon with her phone in her hand as

if it were something broken from its heart: «My son is in Saudi Arabia... and the phone crashed. All his messages are inside it. Can it be fixed, or should I get a new one?»

Mostafa looked at the phone: a simple fault, its price at any other shop: a hundred and fifty pounds. And he looked at her face as she said «my son's messages». He fixed it in half an hour, and took the money... and the strange thing happened: he felt that this half-hour had in it a meaning of a different kind. Not money — something cheaper and more precious: **his power turning for someone.**

From the Friday after, Mostafa set a rule in the workshop, written by his hand on a cardboard above the counter: «Friday: first two hours — repair at comfort price for pension women and students.» The word spread in the neighbourhood faster than any paid ad.

A year later: the workshop expanded and he had a craftsman working with him, and the workshop became a station not a place — people connecting to each other, Madame Zeinab telling her story to every woman in the neighbourhood salon, and the supplier started selling to him with a light heart because «this Mostafa is a respectable man.» The whole

neighbourhood market describes what happened in one word: «his luck was good.»

But you know and I know that luck had no work here. What happened has another name entirely:

Before Madame Zeinab... Mostafa was **successful**.

After her he became **meaningful**. And the difference between those two words is this entire chapter.

Why Power Never Completes on Its Own

First: The Broken Ceiling — power that serves only itself... stops charging

In Part One we worked on taking back your mind. And here we complete the truth: the version that took back its mind, set its destination, and arrived... stands before a truth written in our very design: **a human being is not completed by eating for himself alone.**

Not for a moral philosophy — for a design reason: the mind you have charges on achievement for a while... and then it deducts. The first success cheque is a high feeling, the third cheque became an ordinary feeling, and the seventh became routine. Its simple Arabic name: **habitation**. And habituation to success is like habituation to any sweet thing: it loses its taste.

And the emptiness that comes after this arrival isn't a sign of a defect — it's an **electronic notification** from inside you: «this version has reached its ceiling... something bigger is waiting.» And that bigger thing isn't more of the same story — it's something of a different kind entirely: an impact in someone else's life.

Second: Service isn't charity... it's an exchange of a higher level

There's a common understanding of service that turns it into a form of pity: one above gives to one below. This understanding is wrong... and it's wrong with no relation to ethics even — it's an operational error.

Mostafa's service to Madame Zeinab wasn't charity: it was

an investment in a currency deeper than money — **meaning**. And that meaning became something between him and himself: you're not spending time... you're spending time on something that stays standing after you get up from the seat.

And in the honesty of this book: there's a real material return, and it reached Mostafa in money and reputation and people — but let's be organized: **the return isn't the reason**. Whoever serves for the return becomes a merchant... and commerce has no meaning in it, it has a calculation. Whoever serves

without calculating, finds the return coming to him behind his back — without him opening an account. The simple law of life: whoever plants in people's lives... finds it in his harvest, many times over.

Third: Your service comes out of your skill... not out of your pocket

The first trap in the door of service: «I don't have money to serve.» And the answer is simpler than the trap: service doesn't want your pocket — it wants **the strongest thing you have** and your time.

Mostafa didn't buy Madame Zeinab a new phone. Mostafa spent what he had: **his skill**. And the equation is fixed in every case: you need to find the intersection point between what you're skilful at... and what people need. That point's name is **your service**. What's required of you is only the question: «What am I good at... and who needs this skilfulness and can't afford to pay for it?»

The answer is always there — because every skill in the world has people who need it and can't manage.

Fourth: A small sustained service... beats a big one-time service

The last understanding that must be set right before the exercise: impact isn't measured by the size of a single day. It's measured by continuation.

A big campaign on one day... makes one quick laugh and ends. Two hours every week for a year = **104 hours of service**. That's a full share in the life of a neighbourhood. And those 104 hours are built on the same muscles of the whole book: a closed decision (from chapter 2), and the daily watering's stability (from chapter 3), and a return at the smallest degree if a Friday was missed (from chapter 4). Sustained service was never a state of enthusiasm — it's a full planting system.

Chapter Exercise: Two Hours of Khidmaty

What you need: the old destination page, a pen, and one quiet question.

1. **Write your core skill.** Not everything you know how to do — the strongest thing you do: the thing people say about it «this one's an artist at that.» (And remember: a skill doesn't have to be your job. Cooking, teaching, phones, arranging, words that calm.)

2. **Ask: who needs it around me?** In the building, in the street, at your work, online. People who need it **and can't afford to pay for it.**

3. **Set the dose:** two hours a week. Not less... and not more in the first month (service from strength, not from burnout — the self-compassion rule from the storm chapter works here too).

4. **Do the first service this week.** Just one. Small. With your skill — not with your money.

5. **Mark it on the watering page.** A mark of a different kind: the mark that gets counted to the credit of someone else's life. (And for the right arrangement: it's forbidden to do it so you can post it. Posting evaporates the meaning... and this meaning is what you want to harvest.)

6. **The protection rule:** your service has its boundaries. «No» isn't an ugly word in the Khidmaty dictionary — because service without limits turns the sweetest thing in your life into the first thing that burns you.

And four common traps:

- **«I don't have money to serve»:** we talked above — service is from skill and time. Most people have set

aside for serving people 10% of the free time that goes to their phone alone.

- **«My service has to be big to count»:** Madame Zeinab's service was one phone. All the rest came after it.

- **«I'll serve when I get myself sorted first»:** The order is flipped — meaning is part of the sorting. A person completes himself while serving... not serving when he's complete.

- **«People will exploit me»:** That genuinely happens when there are no limits — which is why the sixth step in the exercise isn't a luxury.

The mark of success: after the first small service with your skill, you'll feel something light in your chest. Not the hero feeling — quieter and deeper: the same «this is mine» feeling you felt on the destination page... but one degree bigger: not «this is mine»... **«this is me.»**

Sentence of the Week

«Strong... doesn't mean complete.»

Write it and put it in front of you. All week, every time you feel your power — in your work, in your system, in your discipline — stop a second and ask: «This power... whom is it serving?» If the answer is still

«only me»... then there's something missing in you that doesn't need money or chances: two hours.

Before We Close the Chapter...

Mostafa is now thirty-four. The workshop became three workshops in three neighbourhoods — and the cardboard with the Friday offer written on it is still there above the counter in all three, in the same hand. And Madame Zeinab has begun telling the story in the salon as an example of «the lovely people in the neighbourhood»... and she never knew she was the one who started the whole story.

The ladder is done. Destination... decision... watering... storms... people... and impact. That's the whole ladder. But before we reach the end and hand you the 90-day plan... there's one last thing in the book: **stories.**

Real people who walked this same ladder — from the first rung to the last. Not celebrities or names in the papers: people like Karim you met in the first chapter, like Tarek and Mona and Dalia and Omar. The next chapter puts these stories next to each other — so you see the ladder walking in the lives of people of flesh and blood... and find your own place among the stories.

«Stories of Part Two.»

Chapter Seven: Stories of Part Two

There's something words fall short of and a story does with ease: **words get locked in the mind... a story stays running.**

That's why Part One closed with a stories chapter, and this part will close with one like it. The stories coming are from real life — the names have been changed, and the details arranged, but the ladder they're walking is the same ladder you've been walking with me from the start of the book: **destination → decision → watering → storms → people → impact.**

Five stories. Each one shows you a rung of the ladder as it works in a real life.

Nabeela's Story: Destination at 48

Nabeela is a commerce graduate, class of '99. From the day she married she was a housewife — twenty full years, three children who grew up and got educated. And on an ordinary day, while tidying the kitchen cabinet, she asked herself the question that hadn't been asked for twenty years: «Where am I going?»

She tried to answer with the official answer: «my children.» But she heard in her head this part's question: «and after them?»

And Nabeela's destination page turned into something simple: «a year from today: a computer accounting diploma... and a half-time job.» The people around her said the expected sentence: «at your daughters' age? meaning if it happens, a diploma won't come in a full year?» And Nabeela answered with the truth from the first chapter without having read it: **«This year will pass anyway, whether I'm like this or not... my only question is: where will it pass?»**

A year later: Nabeela is a half-time accountant in a clinic, first salary in her hand... the first time in twenty years she feels «this is mine.» And the rung the story shows you: **destination never ages... no matter how old you are when you ask.**

Youssef's Story: The Night of Decision and the Day of Drought

Youssef is twenty-four, working and enrolled in an evening course. His old problem: 8 p.m. he opens the phone... and stays up till two. And the course gets taken in vain.

Youssef didn't try to «organize his time» — he tried that for years and you know the result. Youssef did one thing: a night of decision. He sat, and calculated the standing bill in numbers: a full year on the same

system = **700 hours of staying up** and zero courses. And he wrote the decision sentence in the closed form, and signed: «I get up at 6. I won't try... I get up.»

Day nine was easy. Day twelve... the day of drought came exactly as we agreed: a crush at work, his mind drifted, and an inner voice: «rest today only. It doesn't make a difference.»

What saved Youssef was one thing: **the page**. Not enthusiasm — the page that had the 700-hour bill on it, hanging next to the mirror. He looked at it for ten seconds... and got up at 6:10. Not 6 sharp — 6:10. The smallest degree... and he carried on without opening the «why?» file again. Youssef finished the course today in five months... and is studying for a second certificate.

The rung: **the decision isn't built on enthusiasm... it's forged from the page. And the page wins the day of drought.**

Soad's Story: Watering of 14 Months

Soad is thirty-five, an administrative employee, and has a hand — God bless it — in the kitchen. The dream: a home baking project from the house — half her income from her own oven.

The first five months were the expected disaster: three orders a month... twice from her family. And month six and seven and eight: the gap. The street is full of people like her, the feed is full of better than her, and the daily voice: «no use.»

Soad could have done one of two things: close the oven... or open every day the order number and wait for the miracle. She did a third thing — she made a **watering page**: every day one hour only, divided: developing a recipe, a photography trial, an online page. And she put the forbidden line on the page: «the harvest is forbidden from the count before 90 days.»

Month ten: the first full Eid order — **4,800 pounds** in one week. Not wealth... that's proof of direction. Today, after four years, this kitchen has become Soad's main work. And the rung: **the harvest never comes on its time... it comes when it finds sustained watering.**

Uncle Ramadan's Story: The Storm and the People

Uncle Ramadan is fifty-five. A doorman of a building in downtown for thirty years. The storm wasn't a deduction or a failure — the storm was his wife's operation, and a full month between home and

hospital, while he himself is a diabetic and blood pressure patient.

When he went back to work, he tried to «return complete» like anyone: from the first day full energy and full cleaning. Five days... and his leg gave out on him. And he stopped: if he kept on like this he'd fall... and no one would catch him.

Uncle Ramadan — without reading the storm chapter — made a smallest-degree rule by his hand: first week, he opens the gate and arranges the doorman's table only... and then sits. Second week: the gate and the greetings to the residents. Third: full work. A return at the smallest degree — without breaking the leg.

And the story has the second half of the ladder: **the people**. The older lady on the third floor — a retired doctor — brought him the diabetes and blood pressure medicines she takes herself: «no need to call me needed.» And the building's children started carrying furniture with him. And the engineer on the fifth floor, when he learned the story, said one sentence to him: «if you need anything... I'm on the fifth floor. Just knock.»

The rung: **the return is degree by degree... and who's around you is measured at storm time, not at ease time.**

Mariam's Story: Two Hours

Mariam is nineteen, a student in a theoretical college, and one of the people most keen to revise with her friends before exams. One time she noticed something: while explaining to her friend, she studies better than by herself.

Instead of letting something sweet die in a cafeteria seat, she did something simple: a revision session every Thursday, two hours, in the empty lecture hall — for free, for anyone in the class who wanted to come. First Thursday: four. Second month: thirteen. The year after: forty students, and four from her class became teaching with her.

When they asked her why she does this when she herself has exams — she answered with one sentence that summarizes the «Whose service» chapter without knowing it: «I'm very happy and I don't know how to say why.»

The rung: **two sustained hours... build something bigger than their owner.**

The Whole Ladder in Five Stories

- **Nabeela** → destination: the right question reaches you even if it was twenty years late.

- **Youssef** → decision: the page saves you on the day of drought... and enthusiasm doesn't.
- **Soad** → watering: the harvest comes after you leave its count and work on your watering.
- **Uncle Ramadan** → storm and people: the return is degree by degree... and people show their colours at the time of trouble.
- **Mariam** → impact: two hours a week become something bigger than you.

And notice one last thing — perhaps the most important thing in this chapter: **not one of them was without a fall**. Nabeela missed three and a half months of watering in her first year... and came back a degree. Youssef fell on day twelve. Uncle Ramadan fell literally. And the only difference between them and the ones who stand in the same place for years: **the degree of return**. Falling isn't the difference... returning is the difference.

Chapter Exercise: Your Place in the Stories

This exercise is light — but it's in the book for a reason: so these stories keep their place with you.

1. **Go back to the five stories and choose the closest to your life.** Not the one you love... the

closest. The first story that made you feel «this is me» — that's yours.

2. Locate your place on the ladder: where are you standing right now? Destination? Decision?

Watering? Storm? People? Impact?

3. Write the first step on your missing rung. One step — and its smallest degree is ready and waiting in its chapter.

And four last traps:

- **«That's luck»:** notice the order: luck in these stories came after the decision and the watering... it never came before them.

- **«Their circumstances are better than mine»:** review Uncle Ramadan's story before this sentence.

- **«I'm different from them»:** right — the ladder doesn't need to look like you... it just needs you to walk on it.

- **«These stories scare, they don't encourage»:** it means you're looking at the distance between you and them. Look only at the first rung... and the rest comes one after another.

The mark of success: a story from the five stayed with you after you closed the book... and you started

telling it to yourself while you work. The story you carry with you — that's the compass of your place on the ladder.

Sentence of the Week

«**They started... doesn't mean they're different from you.**»

Write it and put it in front of you. All week, every time you find yourself saying about any successful person «those are other people» — remember that every one of these stories used to say the same sentence... before the first rung. And the difference between «other people» and you: one rung. That's all.

Before We Close the Chapter...

These stories aren't sacred exceptions. They're a sample of a rule: **the ladder works with anyone who walks it.** And «anyone» here means: someone who has a destination and a decision and a watering and a degree of return and people and a service... and time. Every one of the five stories had in it someone just like you — who asked himself a question, and wrote a page, and started a degree.

One last page remains in the book... but this one isn't a page like the others: **the end.** It holds the last message

I want to hand you, carried from the first line of the introduction... and it holds **the 90-day plan**: the first 90 days of your destination's year, drawn rung by rung with all the tools of the book — the destination page, the night of decision, the watering page, the return-day plan, the five tally, and two hours of Khidmaty.

The next chapter isn't a chapter... it's a key being handed over.

«**The End: A Last Message and a 90-Day Plan.**»

The End: A Last Message... and a 90-Day Plan

The Last Message

If you remember, we began this book from a specific point: you finished the 21-day plan from Part One, and the engine started running... but the car was still standing. And the promise was clear: Part One took back your mind, and this part leads your life.

Now you're here. The last page. And I want to stand with you in it for a moment before you close the book and rise.

First: thank you. Not courtesy — real thanks. A person who reaches the end of a book about leadership and change is someone who passed a silent exam on himself: that he genuinely wants. This book isn't a novel to be beautified in your living room — it's a workshop, and the ones who finish a workshop seriously are few. And you are one of them.

Second: let's agree on one last thing with our usual honesty. This book — with its introduction and its seven chapters and its stories — **isn't what will change your life**. If you return it to the shelf as is, it'll be the most beautiful thing you read this year... and a

house of clothes with no one to wear them. The tools inside aren't «ideas» — they're pages: a destination page, a night of decision, a watering page, a return-day plan, a five tally, two hours of Khidmaty. Six pages. What will change your life is this paper and you sitting on it with a pen... and I'm not with you in this moment — you are the one who's with you.

Third — and the most important: I want to tell you that it doesn't matter how much you've arrived from this book. Some people will take from the book one question: «Where am I going?» And some will take all six pages. And both have won. Because of the truth I built the whole book on from the first line: **change isn't a leap — it's a rung**. And any rung starts from here... the point of enough.

And finally: from today, you're not a reader of this book. You're one of its people. And I have one last piece of advice for them... and it's the plan below.

The 90-Day Plan: The First Quarter of Your Destination's Year

The 21-day plan from Part One had one mission: to start the engine. The 90-day plan's mission is one degree higher: **to lead the car the first 3 months of your destination's year**. 90 days = the first quarter of

the 365. If you walk it as is... the rest of the year becomes the same system at a larger degree.

The plan is three phases, thirty days each. And it's built entirely on the book's tools — so it's a quick reference, next to each step is its chapter.

Phase One: The Foundation (Days 1 → 30)

- **Day 1:** the destination page complete — the three sentences, the choice, the appearance line, the day's rung. (Chapter 1)
- **Day 2:** the first day's rung — the first X mark on the watering page. (Chapter 3)
- **Days 3-7:** daily watering at the exact same rung. No enlarging — enlarging comes later.
- **Day 8:** the night of decision — the standing bill, the change bill, the closed sentence, the signature... and the first bill paid before you sleep. (Chapter 2)
- **Days 9-13:** watering. The voice will come — it doesn't matter: the page has won it.
- **Day 14:** the first expected dry point. The mark of the plan here isn't a failure in it — one minute is enough. (Chapter 2)
- **Days 15-29:** watering. If a day passes: tomorrow two centimetres. (Chapter 3)

- **Day 30:** first-month review: count only the X's. The harvest is forbidden from the count entirely.

Phase Two: Immunity (Days 31 → 60)

- **Days 31-32:** the five tally — five names, weekly hours, charger/drainer/neutral. (Chapter 5)
- **Day 33:** the one decision for the dose + the chargers list.
- **Days 34-39:** add one charger: a message, a sitting, a group.
- **Day 40:** the return-day plan — three habits and the smallest degree for each, hanging next to the watering page. (Chapter 4)
- **Days 41-59:** watering. And if a storm happens: the smallest degree for the first 7 days... and one added degree from the second week.
- **Day 60:** second-month review: the number of X's + the energy budget — do the sittings charge or drain?

Phase Three: Impact (Days 61 → 90)

- **Day 61:** if the X's are above 25 in the month: add one rung only. (Chapter 3)
- **Days 62-69:** ordinary watering.

- **Day 70:** the two hours of Khidmaty exercise — your core skill + who needs it around you. (Chapter 6)
- **Day 71:** the first small service. A mark of the other kind on the page.
- **Days 72-89:** two hours of service weekly + sustained daily watering.
- **Day 90: the big day** — the first day in your life you're allowed to reckon the harvest. Look at the destination page written on day 1... and look at yourself. That's all. That's all that's in the plan.

The Four Rules of the Plan (written so they stay hanging)

1. **The order isn't a suggestion.** No jumping steps — each phase builds the one after it.
2. **A day passed? Two centimetres tomorrow.**
The plan never gets cancelled.
3. **A week passed? The smallest degree for 7 days.** And after it carry on from where you are — not from the start.
4. **The first 90 days: the count is watering only.**
The harvest gets counted from day 90... and before it, it lies.

And After the 90 Days?

These 90 days aren't a complete plan — they're **the first quarter of your destination's year**. And the thirty-two months after them need from you only two things: the same system... and a slightly bigger rung each quarter. The watering continues, a review every 30 days, a storm happens → the smallest degree, and the service grows by an hour each quarter. And with that you will have lived the year that makes a difference — not the year that passes.

And by the way — this part isn't the last word. On the road is a third part of the series, about the stage after the 90 days: when your destination's first year ends, and the question shifts from «where am I going?» to a bigger question: «**and who will I serve with what I've reached?**» — about leadership: when you move from someone leading his own life... to someone handing the ladder to someone else. If you walk this 90-day plan and find yourself wanting to continue — I'm waiting for you in the same seat.

But before we close... the last sentence in the book. And the whole book was made so you reach it... and rise:

«I finished the book... doesn't mean I finished.»

Rise. A page... a pen... and today's rung is waiting for you.

— Mohamed Ismail